

RULES · 2–4 PLAYERS

BUMBLE & BLOOM



Grow a meadow, gather nectar and bank it in your comb. The player with the most points at the end wins.

First game

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WARNING: CHOKING HAZARD—

Small parts. Not for children under 3 yrs.

What's in the box

Use Fig. 1 to sort the shared pieces. Colony pieces are on page 3.



Fig. 1a. Clover



Fig. 1b. Lavender



Fig. 1c. Poppy



Fig. 1d. Sunflower

The game has **32 flower tiles**: 8 of each kind. Each kind has 4 single-blossom, 3 double-blossom and 1 triple-blossom tile. 6 tiles show a nest.



Fig. 1e. 96 nectar
24 of each kind



Fig. 1f. 1 Old Oak tile
+ 1 two-part tree



Fig. 1g. 1 wasp + base



Fig. 1h. 1 queen + base



Fig. 1i. 12 Queen's Wishes (secret goals)

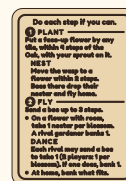


Fig. 1j. 4 double-sided player aids

The tree and each beehive are two halves that slot together and stand in the + hole of their tile. Take them apart to put the game away.

Choose a colony

All four colonies play by the same rules. Match yours by shape (Fig. 2).



Fig. 2a. Bumblebees
Circle



Fig. 2b. Honeybees
Hexagon



Fig. 2c. Mason Bees
Square



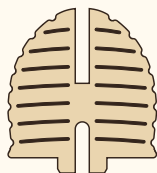
Fig. 2d. Carpenter Bees
Log



Each player gets 1 hive tile with a two-part beehive, 1 comb board, 1 sprout tray, 3 bees with numbered bases, 8 sprouts and 1 player aid. The box contains 4 hives, 4 boards, 12 bees with bases and 32 sprouts.



Fig. 2e. Hive tile and beehive halves.



Your 2 starting bees

Bees 1 and 2 begin on your hive. Bee 3 hatches later (page 11).



Fig. 2f. Your sprout tray holds the 8 sprouts you have not planted yet.

Count the dots along one edge of the base. The same number is repeated on the opposite edge. Match this number to its saddlebag row (Fig. 3).



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Your board: comb & bags



Fig. 3. Bumblebee bases 1–3 align with their matching saddlebag rows.

Comb = points

The 12 numbered wells on the left start empty. Bank into them in number order, following the engraved trail.

The bee, wings, basket and jelly jar icons mark rewards. Gain a reward as soon as you fill its well (page 11).

Your sprout tray beside the board holds the sprouts you have not planted yet.

Bags = carried nectar

Keep each bee's tokens in its own row, in collection order.

Each bee starts with room for 2 nectar. Leave each row's third well, the basket, unused until you gain baskets. Bee 3's row opens when it hatches.

Carried nectar is not banked. A bee brings nectar home to score it.

Set up the game

- 1 Choose the first player.** Whoever last saw a bee takes the queen (page 7).
- 2 Place the Oak and hives.** Copy the map on page 6. Put the queen holder's hive at position 1. Assign the other positions in order to the left. Sit behind your hive.
- 3 Take your colony pieces** (page 3). Put the tree on the Oak, and your beehive and bees 1 and 2 on your hive. Bee 3 waits beside your empty board. Put your 8 sprouts in your sprout tray beside the board.
- 4 Prepare the flowers** using the table below. Shuffle them face down as the stack; turn 3 face up beside it as the row.
- 5 Set out nectar and the wasp.** Sort the 96 nectar by kind into the lid. Put the wasp beside the meadow.
- 6 Choose a secret Wish.** Shuffle and deal 3 Wishes to each player. Read pages 17–18 before choosing; your kept Wish is scored at the end (page 15). Keep 1 face down and return the other 2 to the box unseen.

PLAYERS**FLOWERS TO USE****4**

Use all 32 flower tiles.

2 or 3

Use 28 flowers. Remove 2 plain single-blossom lavenders and 2 plain single-blossom sunflowers.

“Plain” means no nest. Box unused colonies and flowers. Use all nectar. With 4 players, complete the opening plants on page 7.

Place the starting meadow

The Oak is the centre. Each hive is 2 steps away, leaving 1 empty hex space between hive and Oak. Align the hex edges and leave the gaps empty for now.

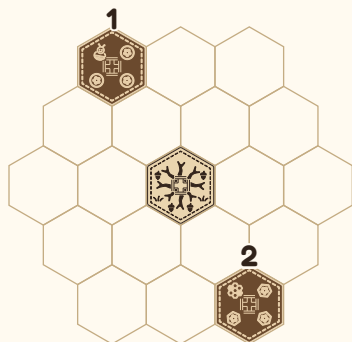


Fig. 4a. 2 players

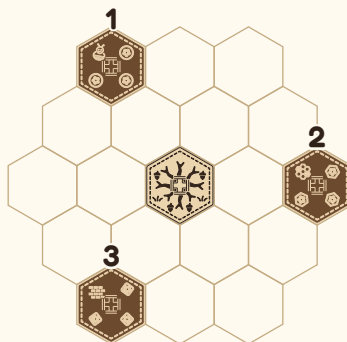


Fig. 4b. 3 players

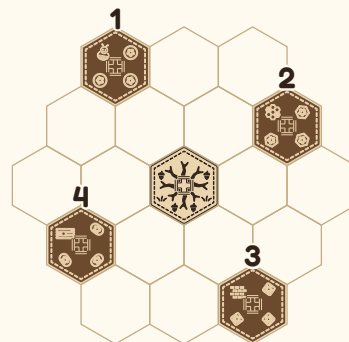


Fig. 4c. 4 players

Fig. 4: use the map for your player count. Each player may choose any colony, and you may rotate the whole arrangement.

There is no board beneath the tiles. The faint hexes in Fig. 4 are spacing guides. The map engraved inside the box is another setup guide.

Keep the meadow aligned

Use the tile width to leave each gap. Later flowers fill these spaces edge-to-edge, or extend the meadow outward up to 4 steps from the Oak.

Keep boards, the row, stack and supply outside the growing meadow.

The queen & the first round



Fig. 5. The queen marks this round's first player.

One turn each

The queen holder starts, then play goes to the left. Keep the queen in place until everyone has had one turn.

After the round, pass her left. The new holder starts the next round.

Example: 4 players

Round 1: A → B → C → D

Round 2: B → C → D → A

Round 3: C → D → A → B

Letters mean seats to the left.

Opening plants

With 4 players, each player plants one flower before round one, in the order below. First to Fourth are the map positions assigned during setup (page 5).

4 players: Third → First → Fourth → Second.

Each player plants a row flower on a space sharing an edge with their own hive tile. Put a sprout on it, refill the row and resolve any nest as usual. Do not fly or dance; opening plants are not turns.

With 2 or 3 players, skip the opening plants. **The queen holder now takes the first full turn.**

Your turn: plant, then fly

Do both steps in order. **You must plant and fly whenever you can**, even if it gains nothing; skip a step only when it is impossible. Only following a dance is optional.

1 · Plant

Place a flower.
Resolve its nest.

2 · Fly

Move one bee.
Resolve its landing.

1 · Plant a flower

- 1 Take any face-up flower from the row. Place it on an **empty space sharing an edge** with any meadow tile: a flower, hive or the Oak. It must be within 4 steps of the Oak.
- 2 Put your sprout on it: you are its **gardener**. If you have none left, plant without a gardener: landings there pay no one. Sprouts stay on their flowers.
- 3 Refill the gap in the row from the stack if possible. If the flower you just planted shows a nest, resolve the wasp before flying (page 14).



Fig. 6. Dots count blossoms. The hanging nest moves the wasp.

In Fig. 6, the flower has 2 blossoms and a nest.

When the stack empties, the row shrinks. When both are empty, skip planting.

2 · Fly one bee

Move one hatched bee to a different space within **3 steps** (4 with wings). Count the shortest hex route, including empty spaces. Fly over all pieces.

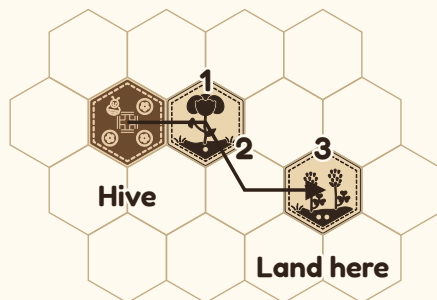


Fig. 7. This flight covers 3 steps. Count spaces entered; the starting space costs nothing. The bee need not land between steps.

Land on a flower

It must have no wasp and fewer bees than blossoms. Your bee needs at least one empty saddlebag.

Take nectar of that flower's kind: 1 per blossom, until its bags are full or that kind runs out. Take the full amount.

Or fly to your hive

Only your own hive; a rival's hive is never a landing. Bank the nectar the bee carries, as explained on page 11. Do not dance.

An empty bee can fly home.

After a flower landing, pay a rival gardener, then resolve the dance (page 10). You cannot land on the Oak or an empty space. Bees already there are unaffected.

A flower landing & the dance

Finish this sequence before the next turn. All new nectar comes from the supply.

- 1 The landing bee collects.** Fill its saddlebags as on page 9.
- 2 A rival gardener banks 1.** If the flower has another player's sprout, that player banks matching nectar. Your own sprout pays you nothing for your own landing.
- 3 Your bee dances.** Starting with the player on your left, offer each rival one chance to follow. Each may move one eligible bee to this flower, or decline.

Check each follower

Its bee must be hatched, on a different space, within its own flight range (3 steps, or 4 with its colony's wings) and have a free saddlebag, and the flower must still have room.

Check when that rival's chance arrives.

What a follower takes

With 3 or 4 players, a follower takes 1 matching nectar. With 2 players, it takes 1 per blossom until its saddlebags are full, like a landing bee. Followers do not pay the gardener or dance.

The dancer banks 1

As soon as the first follower has moved, bank 1 matching nectar if the supply has one, even if that follower is the gardener. Later followers pay you nothing.

Following is free: it costs no turn. The gardener may follow too.

Bank nectar & grow your comb

Bank means place nectar in your next empty numbered comb well. Banking is never optional. Once banked, nectar stays there and its flower kind still matters for scoring.

Coming home

Move carried tokens into the comb in the order collected, oldest first. Bank only what fits. The newest tokens stay with that bee.

Gardener or dance income

Take the matching token straight from the supply to your comb. No space or no token means no payout.

Rewards happen immediately

4 Hatch bee 3

Stand it on your hive. It can follow dances immediately.

7 Wings

All your bees can fly up to 4 steps, including when following.

10 Baskets

Each of your bees can now carry up to 3 nectar. Use each row's third well, the basket, from now on.

12 Royal jelly

Your comb is full. This is the last round (page 15).

Rewards are permanent. A full comb accepts no more nectar.

Example turn · plant & land

It is the Carpenter Bees' turn. The target (T) is an empty, 3-blossom lavender belonging to the Bumblebees. Both colonies have 3 filled comb wells.

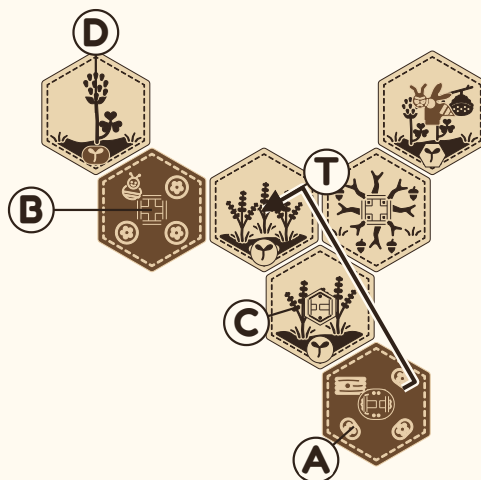


Fig. 8. A: Carpenter 2; B: Bumblebee hive; C: Honeybee 1; T: target; D: new clover.

1 · Plant

Carpenter takes the plain single clover from the row and plants it beside the Bumblebee hive. Carpenter adds a sprout and refills with a plain single lavender.

Continue on page 13. Only the relevant meadow spaces and bees are shown.

2 · Land

Bee A flies 2 steps from its hive to the target. Its empty bags hold 2, so it takes 2 lavender nectar. Bumble banks 1 lavender: well 4 fills.

Example turn · hatch & follow

Bumble hatches bee 3 at its hive. Carpenter offers the dance to Bumble, then Honey, then Mason.

Saddlebags after the dance

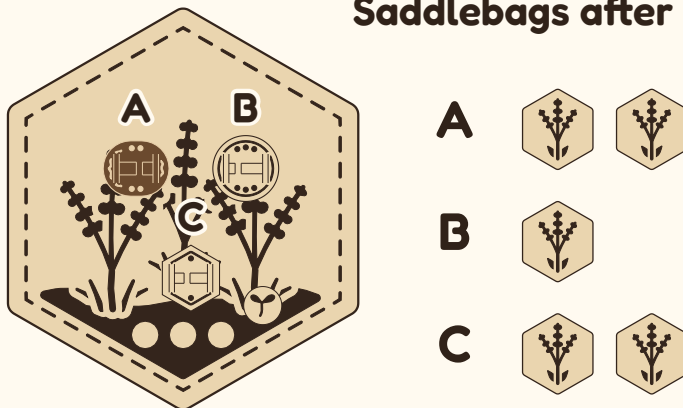


Fig. 9. The lavender is full. A: Carpenter 2; B: Bumblebee 3; C: Honeybee 1.

First follower

Bumble's new bee 3 flies 1 step to the lavender and takes 1 nectar. Carpenter banks 1 lavender and hatches its own bee 3 at home.

Second follower

Honeybee 1 flies 1 step and takes 1 lavender. It already carried lavender; its bags are now full. Carpenter gains no second dance payout.

The flower is full: Mason cannot follow. Carpenter's new bee cannot follow its own dance. Bumble takes the next turn.

When a nest is planted



Fig. 10a. A nest on a flower tile.



Fig. 10b. The wasp uses an octagonal base.

Planting a nest tile (Fig. 10a) makes the planter place the wasp on **any flower within 2 steps of that new tile**. Measure from the new nest, not from the wasp.

- 1 Choose a flower.** The new nest tile itself is eligible. The wasp may stay on its current flower only if it is within this range. A wasp still beside the meadow enters now.
- 2 Sting every bee there.** Each returns all carried nectar to the supply and goes straight to its own hive, whatever the distance, banking nothing. This includes your own bees. Afterwards it flies and follows as usual.
- 3 Leave the wasp on that flower.** No bee can land there until a later nest moves it away. Resume the opening plants during setup; otherwise, fly.

The wasp leaves banked nectar, sprouts and blossom counts unchanged.

Flying to or following onto an old nest tile does not move the wasp.

Finish the round, then score

The end is triggered as soon as **any comb fills** or **the flower row and stack are both empty**. Keep playing to the end of this round.

The player on the queen holder's right has the last turn, so everyone has taken the same number of turns. If that turn is already in progress, finish it, including its dance.

SCORE	COUNT AT THE END
Comb	Score 1 point per filled well.
Blends	Score 2 points per complete set of all 4 flower kinds in your comb. Each token belongs to only one blend.
Royal jelly	Score 3 extra points for a full comb.
Wishes	Reveal your kept Wish. Add its printed points if it is fulfilled, or subtract 2 if it is missed.

Find the winner

The player with the most points wins. Break ties by most blends, then by a fulfilled Wish, then by most carried nectar, counting all your bees together. Share the win if still tied.

Carried nectar gives no points. Flowers give no points.

Check your Wish only at the end. Nectar and flowers that satisfy it still score normally. A missed Wish can take a score below zero.

Count your blends

A blend needs one banked nectar of each kind. Make as many complete sets as possible.



Fig. 11. 2 complete blends and 3 spare tokens. Each picture is one banked nectar.

The smallest count is 2, so Fig. 11 makes 2 blends.

PART OF SCORE	POINTS
11 filled wells	11
2 blends × 2	4
No royal jelly: 1 well empty	0
Subtotal before Wishes	15

If your kept Wish is Sunflower Queen, it adds 4 and the final score is 19. If you kept Full Comb instead, the missed Wish subtracts 2 and the final score is 13.

Wishes about your comb

Only nectar banked in your comb counts. Your kept Wish is the only card you ever hold: look at it whenever you like; cards are never drawn during play.

The number at right is the reward for a Wish that is met.

Clover Queen Your comb holds five or more clover nectar.	4	Sunflower Queen Your comb holds five or more sunflower nectar.	4
Lavender Queen Your comb holds five or more lavender nectar.	4	Full Comb All twelve wells of your comb are full.	5
Poppy Queen Your comb holds five or more poppy nectar.	4	Wildflower Your comb holds nine nectar, counting up to three of each flower.	4

Wildflower counts at most 3 of each kind: 3 clover, 3 lavender and 3 poppy meet it. A fourth of a kind neither counts nor hurts.

Wishes about the meadow

“Your flowers” means flowers with your sprout. “Touch” means sharing a hex edge; a group is flowers joined by shared edges.

Sunny Patch Four of your flowers of one kind form one group.	3
Hive Hugger Eight of your flowers are within two steps of your hive.	3
Big Blooms Two of your flowers have three blossoms.	5
Under the Oak All three of your bees stand on flowers that touch the Old Oak.	5
Home Early You have more bees on your hive than any rival has on theirs.	5
Crowd Pleaser Two rival bees stand on your flowers, or one with 2 players.	5

Sunny Patch

Only your own flowers of that kind link the group. Other kinds, rival flowers, hives and the Oak cannot connect it.

Crowd Pleaser

These bees may share a flower or belong to the same rival colony.

Under the Oak, Home Early and Crowd Pleaser count hatched bees only, so Under the Oak needs bee 3 hatched. Under the Oak allows any gardener. Home Early fails if you tie. Hive Hugger counts flowers one or two steps away.

Flight questions

Can I stay put and collect again?

No. Collection requires a landing on a different flower space. You may return on a later turn after leaving.

My bee is full and cannot reach home. What now?

It cannot land on a flower without a free bag. It waits until wings put home within reach, baskets free a bag, or the wasp sends it home. You cannot discard nectar to create room, and you must still fly another bee if one can.

Can several colonies share a flower?

Yes. Count every bee there against its blossom capacity. A 3-blossom flower fits 3 bees total, regardless of colony, including two of your own. Sprouts do not use a bee space.

Can I move nectar between bees?

No. Keep each bee's nectar in its own numbered row. Tokens move to your comb only when that bee flies home, or return to the supply when it is stung.

A bee may follow while its colony's comb is full, if it has a free bag and the flight is legal.

Timing & supply questions

What if the matching nectar runs out?

Take only what is left. Resolve in order: landing bee → gardener → first follower → dancer → later followers. Never substitute another flower kind or take a token from someone's comb.

May a bee land or follow for no nectar?

Yes. Eligibility depends on flight range, flower room and a free bag (and, to follow, a hatched bee on another space), never on the supply. The dance still happens. No nectar available means no collection or payout.

What if a reward unlocks during a dance?

Apply it immediately. A freshly hatched bee may follow when its owner's chance arrives; new wings or baskets can make that flight legal. A player who already declined does not get a second chance.

Which tiles carry a nest?

A single-blossom tile of each kind, a double clover and a double poppy: 6 in all. With 2 or 3 players every nest tile stays in the game.

Do I ever draw a Wish during play?

No. The Wish you kept at setup is your only card until scoring. You may look at it whenever you like.

Home banking transfers carried tokens, so it works even with an empty supply.

Words at the table

Bank

Put nectar into the next empty numbered comb well. Never optional.

Blend

A blend contains one nectar of each flower kind in your comb.

Blossoms

Blossoms are flower heads, also shown as dots. They set collection and bee capacity.

Comb

The numbered scoring wells on your board form your comb.

Gardener

Your sprout on a flower makes you its gardener.

Meadow

The Oak, hives and planted flowers form the meadow.

Room

A flower has room if it has fewer bees than blossoms.

Round

Each player takes one turn per round, starting with the queen holder.

Row & stack

Choose from the face-up row. Refill it from the face-down stack.

Saddlebags

Track each bee's carried nectar in its own board row.

Space

A hex position in the meadow grid, empty or filled.

Step

One hex edge to the next space. Every distance in the game counts steps this way.

Supply

The shared nectar tokens in the lid form the supply.

Rule index

Use these page numbers to settle a question. The back cover is the one-page turn reference.

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Your turn at a glance

Plant and fly if you can. New nectar only while supply and space allow.

1 · Plant. Place a row flower on an empty space touching the meadow, within 4 steps of the Oak. Add your sprout if you have one; refill the row if possible. If you planted a nest, place the wasp on a flower within 2 steps of that tile. Return all bees there to their hives and their nectar to the supply.

2 · Fly. Move one hatched bee to a different space within 3 steps (4 with wings). Choose your own hive, or a flower with room and no wasp. Flower landings require a free bag. At home, bank carried nectar in order until your comb is full; do not dance. On a flower, take 1 matching nectar per blossom until your bags are full. A rival gardener then banks 1 matching nectar.

Dance. After a flower landing, rivals in order to your left may each follow with one bee under the same landing limits. A follower takes 1 matching nectar; with 2 players, 1 per blossom until its bags are full. You bank 1 after the first follower only. Followers never pay the gardener or dance.

Well 4	Well 7	Well 10	Well 12
Hatch bee 3 at home.	Fly up to 4 steps.	Bees can carry up to 3 nectar.	Finish this round.

Round & end. Each player takes one turn, then pass the queen left. End when any comb fills or the row and stack empty; finish the round, the player to the queen holder's right last.

Score 1 point per filled well, 2 per blend and 3 for a full comb. Add your Wish's points if it is fulfilled, or subtract 2 if not. Break ties by most blends, then a fulfilled Wish, then most carried nectar. Share the win if still tied.